

INTAKE-ARBITER -- FREE-COOLING DECISION REPORT

Data centres over-cool, continuously, because nobody can promise them the hours ahead. A chiller plant needs hours of notice to change mode, and a thermometer only ever reports NOW -- so the mechanical chillers keep running through hours that outside air could have cooled for free. FortyGuard closes that gap with heat intelligence 2 m above the ground, the height a ground-mounted condenser actually breathes. This agent turns that forecast into an hour-by-hour schedule carrying a calibrated safety bound.

THE SITE

Location Iron Mountain VA-3, VA -- station KHEF, America/New_York
Committed pair OSM 1283698132 -> 996723586
Iron Mountain VA-3 / Iron Mountain VA-1
Facade gap 160.1 m between the two halls
Weather record 42,554 real hourly records from KHEF
Plume physics 576 steady-state solves on this site's own footprints; worst intake rise 0.4586 C at 120 deg

FortyGuard data: weather and geometry are this site's own; the four measured FortyGuard level offsets and the N-26 coverage record are Ashburn's, because only Ashburn has forecast/outcome day pairs. Quote the hours for this site; quote the coverage for Ashburn.

THIS REPORT IS A SNAPSHOT, NOT THE LIVE PAGE

The interface recomputes the decision for whatever configuration a reader selects. This file was generated at build time for the ONE configuration named below, chosen because it is the configuration in which this site's agent does the most while still changing mode at least once. If the numbers on screen differ from the numbers here, the configuration differs -- compare the two lists before concluding anything else.

Day 2023-04-11 (crossing)
Plant limit 18.0 C
Notice required 3 h
Forecast skill 0.50 relative to persistence
Level anchor sensor
Condenser bank longest facade
Switch budget 1 mode changes per day
Minimum dwell 3 h
Max dew point 15.0 C (Green Grid WP#46 p.6)

WHAT THE AGENT DID ON THIS DAY

The agent ran free cooling for 3 of 24 hours with 1 mode change. The reactive incumbent took 12 hours -- 9 more -- but declared 1 unsafe hour against the agent's 0. The incumbent had to break its own switch budget 1 time to stay safe; the agent never did. 9 hours were safe but still ran chillers, because the schedule could not afford them.

Agent 3 of 24 hours free cooling, 1 mode change(s), 0 unsafe hour(s)
Incumbent 12 of 24 hours free cooling, 2 mode change(s), 1 unsafe hour(s)
the incumbent broke its own switch budget 1 time(s) to stay safe
9 hour(s) passed every gate and still ran chillers, because the schedule could not afford them

EVERY HOUR, AND THE REASON FOR IT

hh	mode	safe	binding	bound	limit	actual	margin
00	mechanical	no	refusal	5.382	18.0	5.000	0.884
01	mechanical	yes	switch budget	4.741	18.0	3.890	1.024
02	mechanical	yes	switch budget	3.911	18.0	2.220	0.921
03	mechanical	yes	switch budget	4.191	18.0	2.780	0.879
04	mechanical	yes	switch budget	2.801	18.0	1.110	0.825

05	mechanical	yes	switch budget	1.436	18.0	0.000	0.792
06	mechanical	yes	switch budget	1.936	18.0	-0.610	1.097
07	mechanical	yes	switch budget	4.466	18.0	3.890	1.403
08	mechanical	yes	switch budget	8.356	18.0	8.890	2.132
09	mechanical	no	refusal	11.556	18.0	12.780	2.570
10	mechanical	yes	-	15.856	18.0	16.670	2.688
11	mechanical	no	refusal	19.227	18.0	20.367	2.065
12	mechanical	no	dry-bulb	21.136	18.0	22.780	1.518
13	mechanical	no	dry-bulb	22.801	18.0	23.890	1.184
14	mechanical	no	dry-bulb	24.186	18.0	24.440	1.070
15	mechanical	no	refusal	25.575	18.0	25.560	0.974
16	mechanical	no	dry-bulb	25.290	18.0	25.000	1.034
17	mechanical	no	refusal	24.734	18.0	24.440	1.185
18	mechanical	no	dry-bulb	24.183	18.0	22.780	1.481
19	mechanical	no	dry-bulb	21.406	18.0	18.330	1.634
20	mechanical	no	dry-bulb	19.746	18.0	15.560	1.747
21	FREE	yes	-	17.246	18.0	12.220	1.596
22	FREE	yes	-	14.741	18.0	11.110	1.477
23	FREE	yes	-	11.966	18.0	8.330	1.130

bound = the agent's 90 %-nominal upper bound on intake air, forecast plus margin
actual = what the intake temperature turned out to be, from the station record
margin = group-conditional forecast error for that hour of day, plus plume spread

THE REASONING, HOUR BY HOUR

00:00 MECHANICAL [refusal]

Mechanical, and the reason is a REFUSAL rather than a temperature. At this wind bearing a building sits between the condensers and the air intake. The dispersion model has no representation of a building standing in the flow, so any number it produced here would be meaningless. The agent declines to certify the hour instead of returning a figure it cannot stand behind.

01:00 MECHANICAL [switch budget]

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 4.741 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: the switch budget of 1 changes per day is already committed elsewhere. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

02:00 MECHANICAL [switch budget]

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 3.911 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: the switch budget of 1 changes per day is already committed elsewhere. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

03:00 MECHANICAL [switch budget]

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 4.191 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: the switch budget of 1 changes per day is already committed elsewhere. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

04:00 MECHANICAL [switch budget]

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 2.801 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: the switch budget of 1 changes per day is already committed elsewhere. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is

also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

05:00 MECHANICAL [switch budget]

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 1.436 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: the switch budget of 1 changes per day is already committed elsewhere. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

06:00 MECHANICAL [switch budget]

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 1.936 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: the switch budget of 1 changes per day is already committed elsewhere. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

07:00 MECHANICAL [switch budget]

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 4.466 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: the switch budget of 1 changes per day is already committed elsewhere. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

08:00 MECHANICAL [switch budget]

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 8.356 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: the switch budget of 1 changes per day is already committed elsewhere. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

09:00 MECHANICAL [refusal]

Mechanical, and the reason is a REFUSAL rather than a temperature. At this wind bearing a building sits between the condensers and the air intake. The dispersion model has no representation of a building standing in the flow, so any number it produced here would be meaningless. The agent declines to certify the hour instead of returning a figure it cannot stand behind.

10:00 MECHANICAL

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 15.856 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: no relaxation of either the switch budget or the dwell would free it, so the surrounding hours are worth more. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

11:00 MECHANICAL [refusal]

Mechanical, and the reason is a REFUSAL rather than a temperature. At this wind bearing a building sits between the condensers and the air intake. The dispersion model has no representation of a building standing in the flow, so any number it produced here would be meaningless. The agent declines to certify the hour instead of returning a figure it cannot stand behind.

12:00 MECHANICAL [dry-bulb]

Mechanical. The upper bound on intake air is 21.136 C against a 18.0 C limit, so it fails by 3.136 C. It would take a limit 3.136 C higher, or a bound 3.136 C tighter, to change this hour.

13:00 MECHANICAL [dry-bulb]

Mechanical. The upper bound on intake air is 22.801 C against a 18.0 C limit, so it fails by 4.801 C. It would take a limit 4.801 C higher, or a bound 4.801 C tighter, to change this hour.

14:00 MECHANICAL [dry-bulb]

Mechanical. The upper bound on intake air is 24.186 C against a 18.0 C limit, so it fails by 6.186 C. It would take a limit 6.186 C higher, or a bound 6.186 C tighter, to change this hour.

15:00 MECHANICAL [refusal]

Mechanical, and the reason is a REFUSAL rather than a temperature. At this wind bearing a building sits between the condensers and the air intake. The dispersion model has no representation of a building standing in the flow, so any number it produced here would be meaningless. The agent declines to certify the hour instead of returning a figure it cannot stand behind.

16:00 MECHANICAL [dry-bulb]

Mechanical. The upper bound on intake air is 25.290 C against a 18.0 C limit, so it fails by 7.290 C. It would take a limit 7.290 C higher, or a bound 7.290 C tighter, to change this hour.

17:00 MECHANICAL [refusal]

Mechanical, and the reason is a REFUSAL rather than a temperature. At this wind bearing a building sits between the condensers and the air intake. The dispersion model has no representation of a building standing in the flow, so any number it produced here would be meaningless. The agent declines to certify the hour instead of returning a figure it cannot stand behind.

18:00 MECHANICAL [dry-bulb]

Mechanical. The upper bound on intake air is 24.183 C against a 18.0 C limit, so it fails by 6.183 C. It would take a limit 6.183 C higher, or a bound 6.183 C tighter, to change this hour.

19:00 MECHANICAL [dry-bulb]

Mechanical. The upper bound on intake air is 21.406 C against a 18.0 C limit, so it fails by 3.406 C. It would take a limit 3.406 C higher, or a bound 3.406 C tighter, to change this hour.

20:00 MECHANICAL [dry-bulb]

Mechanical. The upper bound on intake air is 19.746 C against a 18.0 C limit, so it fails by 1.746 C. It would take a limit 1.746 C higher, or a bound 1.746 C tighter, to change this hour.

21:00 FREE-COOLING

Free cooling. The 90 %-nominal upper bound on intake air is 17.246 C, which is 0.754 C under the 18.0 C plant limit. That bound is the forecast plus a margin of 1.596 C, and the margin is measured, not chosen: 1.575 C of group-conditional forecast error for this hour of day, plus 0.0210 C for how much the plume could move if the wind direction is off by the amount FortyGuard's forecast is actually off by.

22:00 FREE-COOLING

Free cooling. The 90 %-nominal upper bound on intake air is 14.741 C, which is 3.259 C under the 18.0 C plant limit. That bound is the forecast plus a margin of 1.477 C, and the margin is measured, not chosen: 1.456 C of group-conditional forecast error for this hour of day, plus 0.0210 C for how much the plume could move if the wind direction is off by the amount FortyGuard's forecast is actually off by.

23:00 FREE-COOLING

Free cooling. The 90 %-nominal upper bound on intake air is 11.966 C, which is 6.034 C under the 18.0 C plant limit. That bound is the forecast plus a margin of 1.130 C, and the margin is measured, not chosen: 1.109 C of group-conditional forecast error for this hour of day, plus 0.0210 C for how much the plume could move if the wind direction is off by the amount FortyGuard's forecast is actually off by.

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